

People feel concerned about how large institutions use their personal data, but also powerless over this usage. This powerlessness can stem from the seeming inevitability of structural forces that push new technologies and digital services into every facet of daily life—including but not limited to shopping, fostering social connections, seeking financial support, and accessing healthcare and housing [6]. After all, if all of your personal information is already out there, eagerly vacuumed up by an endless supply of data brokers, what can you, one mere individual, do? What meaning does “privacy” even hold anymore?

I am a **human-computer interaction** and **design** researcher with specialized expertise in **privacy**. I examine how the ever-deepening entanglement of algorithmic technologies and digital services into society has resulted in concrete harms to people’s privacy. These entanglements have necessitated a recalibration of what privacy fundamentally means to people. My research agenda recognizes that today’s legal, political, and technological structures are volatile, and experts meant to address privacy harms are themselves entangled with harmful institutions. Rather than waiting for public policy solutions, we must equip people with strategies for personal and communal resilience and flourishing, through provocative, solidarity-building, and transformational designs.

Drawing from critical computing and games research, I marry concepts of transformational play and provocative design [5] to leverage social tensions as sites for user provocation rather than vulnerabilities to patch. To carry out this work, I employ a combination of speculative design and traditional HCI methods. I gather qualitative empirical evidence of people’s experiences with privacy harms in specific domains, both on a macro scale (via **surveys** [2]) and through direct engagement with communities (in **interviews and focus groups** [6]). I explore **design fiction**, e.g., through story completion and comicboarding, to understand people’s ideals for having structured conversations about privacy harms with authority figures [1]. I create **design probes and technology probes** to inspire solidarity and provoke critical consciousness about people’s relationships with not just large technology institutions, but also each other [3]. Finally, I conduct **systematic literature reviews** to synthesize cross-disciplinary insights and opportunities for human-centered security and privacy [4]. I publish my work at top venues in HCI (**CHI, CSCW, DIS**), security and privacy (**IEEE S&P, USENIX Security**), and AI ethics (**FAccT**).

Moving forward, it’s crucial to build concrete mechanisms for critical reflection about privacy grounded in rich qualitative evidence. Currently, I follow this goal down two key avenues:

- **What can informal conversations about privacy harms reveal about other values like self-knowing, social support, and play?** *What would a formal dataset or empirically-informed taxonomy of privacy harms look like for different stakeholders? How might the insights from such a dataset reshape how researchers, designers, and practitioners can support strengthening security and privacy metacognition—be it through encouraging specific S&P behaviors, developing confidence in asking for help, or activating recognition of exploitative data practices?*
- **How might the concept of “removal” as a methodological lens—for example, imagining life without a specific technology—seed self development?** *How does this lens of removal translate to approaches to work in specific domains, e.g., mental health clinicians who forgo using digital care platforms?*

Through exploring these questions, I hope to create uplifting, social designs to help people navigate ever-changing, challenging, digitally-entangled contexts.

References

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